

10th U.S. History I

Academic Term

Classroom:



Teacher: Mr. O'Neal

Email: seth.oneal@hsv-k12.org

Course Description

This course is a comprehensive study of the first half of American history, from the origins of the United States to the Gilded Age and Progressive Era. This course is designed to emphasize writing, research, and critical thinking skills necessary to prepare students for future courses and life.

Course Objective

By the end of the semester, students should be familiar with important primary sources, research methods, and be able to explain how the United States evolved politically, socially, and economically from the era of pre-colonization (1491) until the end of the Progressive Era (1920).

US History 10 Course Guide (Based on [Alabama Standards](#))

Unit 1: Origins

Unit 2: The Road to Revolution

Unit 3: Early American Government

Unit 4: The Early Republic

Unit 5: Jacksonianism & Manifest Destiny

Unit 6: Industrialization & Sectionalism

Unit 7: Civil War & Reconstruction

Unit 8: Gilded Age, Reform, & Progressivism

Textbook & Resources

Primary sources and secondary sources will be handed out in class or will be posted on the Canvas class page. A free online primary source reader, that can be found at [The American Yawp](#), will sometimes be utilized in class. Websites, such as iCivics, will be used for simulations in class.

Grades

Semesters are divided into two 9-week grading periods. Final grades during the 9-week grading period are composed of the following:

- 60% Summative Assessments: Tests, quizzes, projects, writing assessment. Each unit will contain multiple small quizzes and one test.
- 40% Formative Assessments: In-class assignments, group work, homework.

Tests are composed of primarily multiple choice questions with matching, true/false, and short answer. Quizzes are composed of only short answer questions but are open note.

Projects and writing assignments are graded with a rubric that will be provided to students and be posted on Canvas.

There will be one research paper in this class. Students will be given class time to achieve deadlines for the paper.

Any in-class assignment not completed is expected to be finished as homework, unless otherwise noted.

Late Policy:

- Excused Absences*: Per HCS policy, students with excused absences will have ten days upon their return to make up all missing assignments and tests/quizzes. Should students not make up their work in time, they will receive a zero for those assignments and tests/quizzes.
- Unexcused Absences: Students with unexcused absences on traditional in-class days will be able to turn in late work. Submitted late work will have 5 points deducted from the final grade each day that it is late.
- Students who are present in class on traditional in-class days and choose not to do the assignment will receive a ZERO.

Progress Reports / Report Cards

A progress report will be sent out in the middle of each 9-week grading period. It is the student's responsibility to monitor their grades on PowerSchools. Parents also have access to PowerSchools, and it is recommended that they utilize this tool. It is also recommended that parents create an account to follow along with their students' academic progress on Canvas.

The semester average is calculated as follows: 20% (1st Grading Period) + 20% (2nd Grading Period) + 10% (Semester exam).

Grading Scale

Letter Grade	A	B	C	D	F
Numerical Grade	90 - 100	80 - 89	70 - 79	60 - 69	0 - 59
AP GPA	5	4	3	2	0
Honor GPA	4.5	3.5	2.5	1.5	0
Regular GPA	4	3	2	1	0

Cheating & AI Policy

Cheating will not be tolerated and will result in an automatic ZERO. This includes the submission of someone else's work. This includes rewording, i.e. plagiarism which is a form of cheating, and if detected, will result in an automatic zero; these policies include assignments completed digitally and physically.

Any submitted work written, developed, or created by artificial intelligence (AI), that is not a part of an assignment utilizing the technology, is considered plagiarism and will result in a ZERO. This includes, but is not limited to, using generative technology to reword original thought. AI can be a helpful tool, but should be utilized like an appropriate resource.

Classroom Expectations

Students are expected to come to class on time and prepared. This includes necessary materials and charged HCS laptops.

Students are responsible for make-up work and scheduling make-up tests. If a student is struggling or has questions, they are encouraged to ask. Seek help before falling behind and do not be afraid to email.

Per HCS policy, Students may not use personal wireless communication devices (cell phones, smartwatches, tablets, personal laptops, earbuds, Bluetooth accessories, gaming devices, smart glasses, etc.) or have them on their person at any time during the instructional day.

1st Offense	Device taken to the main office; students may retrieve them at the end of day. Student signs a Cell Phone Violation Acknowledgement Form.
2nd Offense	1 day in the In-House Learning Center (ILC).
3rd Offense	Multiple days in ILC.
4th Offense	Out-of-School Suspension and additional disciplinary action as outlined in the Code of Conduct.

Wired headphones/earbuds for music on laptops will be permitted after instructional time during class.